

Biotechnology English Dialogue Lab

Realistic field-specific dialogues, role-play variations, and observer checklists

Audience: biotech scientists, translational researchers, assay-development teams, platform teams, program managers, alliance managers, business-development staff, and biotech executives

Focus: A high-level biotechnology English curriculum for platform science, assay design, translational evidence, biomarkers, IP, partnerships, investor updates, regulatory-adjacent planning, and scientific-business dialogue.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

Dialogue Practice Method

Read each exchange once for meaning, once for tone, and once for decision structure. Then complete the missing language by selecting one of four options and check the rationale at the end.

1. Platform Technology and Scientific Thesis

Setting

A founder wants to describe the platform as broadly validated.

Speaker	Line
Founder	Use the strongest possible investor language.
Scientific lead	The evidence supports specific models and indications, not every future use case.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm platform, modality, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Founder	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short platform evidence statement. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: platform, modality.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects modality.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	platform
D	approval path

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Use the strongest possible investor language.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify platform and modality against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	We should act now and resolve platform after the result is visible.

Option	Phrase
D	A platform evidence statement is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A founder wants to describe the platform as broadly validated. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the platform evidence statement with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
D	evidence threshold

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

2. Essay Development and Reproducibility

Setting

A partner asks whether a biomarker assay is ready for decision-making.

Speaker	Line
Alliance manager	Say the assay works because the pilot was positive.
Assay scientist	Precision, sensitivity, specificity, controls, and reproducibility need review.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm assay, sensitivity, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Alliance manager	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short assay readiness note. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: assay, sensitivity.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects sensitivity.

Option	Phrase
A	specificity

Option	Phrase
B	reproducibility
C	assay
D	sensitivity

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Say the assay works because the pilot was positive.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify assay and sensitivity against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A partner asks whether a biomarker assay is ready for decision-making. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the assay readiness note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

3. Biomarkers and Translational Strategy

Setting

A team wants to use a biomarker as the main development rationale.

Speaker	Line
Translational lead	Make the biomarker the centerpiece of the clinical story.
Clinical advisor	Biological plausibility, patient relevance, and validation status are different.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm biomarker, patient stratification, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.

Speaker	Line
Translational lead	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short biomarker caveat memo. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: biomarker, patient stratification.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects patient stratification.

Option	Phrase
A	patient stratification
B	surrogate endpoint
C	validation
D	biomarker

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Make the biomarker the centerpiece of the clinical story.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify biomarker and patient stratification against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A team wants to use a biomarker as the main development rationale. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the biomarker caveat memo with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	decision owner

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

4. Preclinical Data Packages

Setting

A board member asks whether animal data prove human efficacy.

Speaker	Line
Board member	Say the model predicts human response.
Preclinical scientist	Model relevance, dose, exposure, safety margin, and limitations must be named.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm in vitro, in vivo, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Board member	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short preclinical evidence summary. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: in vitro, in vivo.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects in vivo.

Option	Phrase
A	in vivo
B	toxicity
C	in vitro
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Say the model predicts human response.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify in vitro and in vivo against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A board member asks whether animal data prove human efficacy. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the preclinical evidence summary with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	operating constraint

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

5. CMC and Scale-Up in Biotech

Setting

A program lead wants to promise rapid scale-up after financing.

Speaker	Line
Program lead	Assure investors that scale-up will be simple.
Process development lead	Yield, process control, comparability, and supply-chain risk are unresolved.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm CMC, yield, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Program lead	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short scale-up risk update. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: CMC, yield.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects yield.

Option	Phrase
A	CMC
B	approval path
C	operating constraint

Option	Phrase
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Assure investors that scale-up will be simple.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify CMC and yield against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A program lead wants to promise rapid scale-up after financing. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the scale-up risk update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

6. IP, Freedom to Operate, and Collaboration

Setting

A collaborator requests broad access to unpublished methods.

Speaker	Line
Alliance manager	Share the materials to keep the relationship warm.
External scientist	Confidentiality, background IP, publication rights, and freedom to operate matter.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm IP, freedom to operate, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Alliance manager	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short collaboration boundary response. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: IP, freedom to operate.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects freedom to operate.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	IP
C	material transfer agreement
D	publication rights

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Share the materials to keep the relationship warm.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify IP and freedom to operate against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A collaborator requests broad access to unpublished methods. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the collaboration boundary response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

7. Investor and Board Updates

Setting

The board wants a clean milestone story before a financing round.

Speaker	Line
CEO	Remove uncertainties from the update.
Program manager	Credibility requires clear milestones, risks, assumptions, and mitigation.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm milestone, runway, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
CEO	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short investor-ready milestone update. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: milestone, runway.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice**1. Complete the field language**

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects runway.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	milestone
C	risk mitigation
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Remove uncertainties from the update.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify milestone and runway against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	A investor-ready milestone update is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
D	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - The board wants a clean milestone story before a financing round. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
B	evidence threshold
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the investor-ready milestone update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

8. Partnering and Business Development

Setting

A potential partner wants exclusive rights after limited data review.

Speaker	Line
Business-development lead	Agree quickly before they lose interest.
Scientific founder	Diligence, territory, field, economics, governance, and data rights need definition.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm term sheet, option, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Business-development lead	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short partnering negotiation brief. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: term sheet, option.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects option.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	term sheet

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Agree quickly before they lose interest.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify term sheet and option against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	decision owner
C	We should act now and resolve term sheet after the result is visible.
D	A partnering negotiation brief is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A potential partner wants exclusive rights after limited data review. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the partnering negotiation brief with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	decision owner
D	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

Platform Technology and Scientific Thesis - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. platform	'platform' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Platform Technology and Scientific Thesis - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify platform and modality against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Platform Technology and Scientific Thesis - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the platform evidence statement with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Assay Development and Reproducibility - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. assay	'assay' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Assay Development and Reproducibility - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify assay and sensitivity against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Assay Development and Reproducibility - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the assay readiness note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Biomarkers and Translational Strategy - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. biomarker	'biomarker' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Biomarkers and Translational Strategy - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify biomarker and patient stratification against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Biomarkers and Translational Strategy - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the biomarker caveat memo with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Preclinical Data Packages - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. in vitro	'in vitro' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Preclinical Data Packages - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify in vitro and in vivo against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Preclinical Data Packages - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the preclinical evidence summary with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

CMC and Scale-Up in Biotech - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. CMC	'CMC' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

CMC and Scale-Up in Biotech - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify CMC and yield against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

CMC and Scale-Up in Biotech - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the scale-up risk update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

IP, Freedom to Operate, and Collaboration - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. IP	'IP' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

IP, Freedom to Operate, and Collaboration - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify IP and freedom to operate against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

IP, Freedom to Operate, and Collaboration - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the collaboration boundary response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Investor and Board Updates - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. milestone	'milestone' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Investor and Board Updates - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify milestone and runway against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Investor and Board Updates - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the investor-ready milestone update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Partnering and Business Development - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. term sheet	'term sheet' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Partnering and Business Development - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify term sheet and option against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Partnering and Business Development - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the partnering negotiation brief with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.